HAIL OF FIRE

WWII COMPANY-LEVEL FAST PLAY RULES

INTRODUCTION

Hail Of Fire is a fast-play miniatures wargame for company-level WWII actions. The game is designed for miniatures 15mm in scale or smaller, based in teams of 2-5 men to a stand, vehicles based individually.

Base size for an average infantry team and man-portable gun team (machine guns/mortars) should be between 1 and 2" in width and length. Leader Teams and Small Teams (usually two-man Teams on a smaller base, ie Bazookas, 2" Mortars, Snipers, FOs) are on bases about half this size, and non-man-portable Gun Teams (most AT guns/howitzers) on larger bases about twice this size.

You'll need a handful of d6's and a single d10. All modifiers apply to target numbers rather than die rolls, so if 4+ is needed to succeed, a +1 modifier means 5+ is now required. Pre-measuring is allowed.

TURNS AND ORDERS

Your force consists of several **Units** (platoons), each made up of **Teams** (a base of troops or single vehicle). Infantry and Gun Units have a **Platoon Leader** Team.

Each Turn begins with the Active Player rolling **Order Dice** to generate **Order Points**. Roll 1d6 for each friendly Platoon Leader and Vehicle Unit deployed on the table. Vehicle Units with half or more Teams destroyed or suppressed contribute no dice.

Each die showing **4+** generates 1 Order Point. Always **add +1** to this total.

The Active Player may spend an Order Point to activate one of their Teams and order them to **Move** or **Fire**. Complete each activation before beginning the next. Teams activated by Order Points may not be activated by Order Point until the Player's next turn.

Once all Order Points are spent, or the Player ends their Turn, the Non-Active Player becomes Active and rolls Order Dice.

HERO POINTS

Before the first turn, both Players roll 1d6 and set it aside, hidden from their opponent. This is the number of **Hero Points** the Player receives. Track spent Hero Points with a separate die, counting up.

Hero Points may be spent to activate Teams as normal. They may also **activate Teams already activated this turn**, or **activate Teams during the opponent's Turn** (after an enemy activation resolves, before the next begins). Teams activated with Hero Points may not activate again until the current turn ends.

When rolling Order Dice, make sure one die is of a different color. This is the **Hero Die**. If the Hero Die **rolls 6**, reveal and discard any remaining Hero Points. Roll 1d6 (keeping it hidden) and gain a number of Hero Points equal to the new roll.

UNITS

Each Player commands a supported Company, typically 5-8 Units on a standard 6'x4' table. All Teams are categorized as either **Infantry**, **Gun**, or **Vehicle** Teams. Some simple example forces have been provided for context, but feel free to use historical orders of battle or forces from other games.

THE "CHECK"

These rules reference various "Checks" (*Training Check, Assault Check, Rally Check*, etc). A Check is a d6 roll trying to equal or beat 4+.

Most forces are assumed to be **Regular**. To represent troops that were notably better or worse, players may assign **Elite** or Poor **quality** to Units before the game begins.

Elite troops **re-roll 1s** on all Checks and when resolving Received Fire Points. Elite crews re-roll 1s on Fire rolls targeting vehicles. Poor troops are the reverse in all cases. When re-rolls are allowed, the second roll stands.

ACTIVATION

An Order Point may be spent to activate a Team. Infantry and Gun Units have a **Platoon Leader (PL)** Team. If the PL is activated, he may also activate any Teams in his Unit to which he has Line of Sight (LoS), and **issue one order to the entire Unit**, or **two orders split between Teams** in the Unit, allowing Teams to split Fire, Move in different directions, or have some Move while others shoot.

Vehicle Units do not have designated Leader Teams. When activated, nominate one Vehicle as the leader; it may activate any Vehicles in its Unit within LoS and issue one order to all, or two orders split between them.